

drinking Myers rum straight from a bottle. That evening of the 508-point drop, we got concerned phone calls from all around the country, similar to the ones we receive when a hurricane warning makes the national news. My father reminded me that *his* father, heavily margined, had gone from millionaire to pauper on that fatal October day in 1929. My friends asked me for more advice on what was happening, and, as usual, I gave answers as if I knew. I wondered if the newscasters who were forced to give answers felt as ridiculous as I did.

Our wealthy friend who had gotten out months ago called to say that all her other wealthy friends who hadn't gotten out were staying in, and that only a fool would get out in this panic.

During the late evening and into the early-morning hours, we sat watching one news account after another of markets crashing around the world, until we were convinced it was time to get out, to protect whatever my wife had left. By the morning, my wife had sold all her stocks—near the bottom, of course. The next day's newspaper was full of moralizing about how *this* Crash was a fitting end to our national profligacy, to young millionaire traders on Wall Street, to borrowing and buying abroad.

But on a more human scale, how did Black Monday affect the various brokers, traders, and investors whose acquaintance I had made in my odyssey as an Average Investor? What were they doing on the day of the 508-point drop? Linda Garrett was on the phone at her local Prudential-Bache office, calming nervous clients. Brokers were nervous as well. It was from Ms. Garrett I first heard the news that a disgruntled investor named Arthur Kane, who had lost millions on this one bad day, expressed his displeasure by killing the branch manager of his local Merrill Lynch with a hastily-purchased revolver. He also wounded his broker and then killed himself. This being a Miami story, it later turned out that Mr. Kane was actually somebody else, having been awarded a new identity for pleading guilty to some earlier fraudulence up North. It was unclear where he got his investment capital in the first place.

Chuck Epstein, the Lind-Waldock spokesman who had kindly showed me around Chicago, had since moved on to the New York Futures Exchange and watched the action on the trading floor. "It